

Team Onboarding Pack

Problem, solution, product idea, implementation plan, and future roadmap for new team members.

Version	Internal beta brief
Prepared	10 June 2026
Audience	New team members, contributors, advisors, and early operators
Owner	NudgeHQ founding team

Core belief: Teams do not fail because work is not happening; teams fail because progress is invisible until it is too late.

How to use this document

- Read sections 1-4 first to understand the product thesis.
- Use sections 5-10 to understand current scope and implementation priorities.
- Use sections 11-17 as the practical onboarding guide for execution.

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1. Executive Summary

NudgeHQ is a B2B SaaS platform for real-time workforce progress tracking. The product helps employees share quick daily updates, blockers, task status, proof, focus, and check-ins while managers, HR, and admins get the right visibility without chasing people across WhatsApp, Slack, spreadsheets, or meetings.

The core idea is simple: teams do not fail because work is not happening; teams fail because progress is invisible until it is too late. NudgeHQ becomes the lightweight daily visibility layer above the tools a company already uses.

One-line positioning

NudgeHQ helps growing teams know what changed today, who is blocked, and what needs attention before work slips.

Current product direction

- Build for early-stage and growing teams that need team clarity without enterprise bloat.
- Keep employee submission lightweight and human.
- Make WhatsApp a key workflow because employees already respond there.
- Turn raw updates into manager-ready intelligence through NudgeAI.
- Keep role views clean: employees see themselves, managers see their team, HR sees people signals, admins see company-wide operations.

2. The Problem

Most teams already have many tools: task boards, HR systems, chats, spreadsheets, email, and docs. But those tools do not automatically answer the daily operating questions leaders ask:

- What actually changed today?
- Which work is blocked?
- Who has not checked in?
- Which tasks are at risk?
- What should a manager follow up on first?
- Which employee wins should be recognized?
- What evidence exists for performance and growth conversations?

Pain points we are solving

- 1 **Managers chase updates manually.** Standups, WhatsApp threads, Slack pings, and spreadsheets become a routine tax.
- 2 **Blockers surface late.** Teams often discover blockers only after a deadline is already slipping.
- 3 **Employees lose visibility.** Good work, proof, consistency, and growth can disappear in scattered messages.

- 4 **HR lacks live people signals.** HR often sees people health too late, after burnout, disengagement, or repeated missed updates.
- 5 **Founders and admins lack one operating view.** Leadership needs a simple command view across tasks, updates, blockers, departments, and reports.

3. Our Solution

NudgeHQ creates a daily operating rhythm where employees submit short signals, NudgeAI interprets the signals, and leaders act from dashboards.

Product loop

- 1 **Employee receives or opens a check-in.** They share location, goals, progress, blockers, proof, and focus in under two minutes.
- 2 **NudgeHQ stores structured work signals.** Tasks, updates, blockers, focus sessions, deep work, and check-ins become useful data.
- 3 **NudgeAI summarizes and detects.** It creates briefs, scores update quality, flags inactivity, highlights blockers, forecasts sprint risk, and suggests appreciation.
- 4 **Managers, HR, and admins act.** Each role sees a scoped dashboard with next actions instead of scattered raw messages.

What makes NudgeHQ different

- **Not another bloated work suite.** It does not try to replace every tool. It becomes the visibility layer above existing tools.
- **WhatsApp-first nudges.** Employees can receive nudges and reply from a channel they already use.
- **Role-scoped dashboards.** Admin, HR, manager, and employee experiences are intentionally separate.
- **AI turns updates into action.** NudgeAI converts small updates into summaries, alerts, forecasts, and manager-ready briefs.
- **Growth evidence for employees.** Progress history becomes useful for reviews, proof, recognition, and development.

4. Target Users and Roles

Admin / Founder / Operations Lead

Needs company-wide visibility, role management, departments, invites, reports, billing, and control over the workspace.

HR Lead

Needs people health, check-in consistency, burnout signals, skill gaps, attendance patterns, growth summaries, and board-ready reporting.

Manager

Needs team tasks, blockers, recent updates, daily standup briefs, active risks, and quick ways to nudge or unblock people.

Employee

Needs a clean personal workspace to see tasks, submit check-ins, report blockers, protect focus, and build a visible growth story.

5. Current MVP Scope

The MVP should prove that teams will adopt a lightweight daily visibility workflow and that leaders get value from the data.

Built / active

- Public landing page with pricing, FAQ, contact, security, and product story.
- Dedicated Why NudgeHQ page comparing against bloated work tools.
- Auth flows: signup, login, email verification, forgot/reset password, Google OAuth callback foundation.
- Company onboarding: company details, departments, employee invites, CSV invite support.
- Role dashboards: admin, HR, manager, employee.
- Employee workspace: dashboard, tasks, check-in, progress curve, growth portal, NudgeSpace, NudgeAI helper, settings.
- Task management: create tasks, assign tasks, update status, report blockers, proof links.
- Progress updates and blocker logging.
- NudgeAI assistant and backend AI endpoints.
- WhatsApp notifications through Twilio: daily nudges, reply webhook, blocker alerts, weekly wins foundation.
- Supabase/PostgreSQL schema for organizations, users, departments, tasks, updates, blockers, invites, AI outputs, notifications, focus, check-ins, deep work, and reports.
- Demo mode kept separate from real product routes.

MVP success criteria

- An admin can create a workspace, invite employees, and assign tasks.
- Employees can submit daily check-ins and task updates without confusion.
- Managers can see tasks, blockers, and recent activity in one place.
- WhatsApp nudges can reach employees with phone numbers and save replies.
- NudgeAI can summarize updates and provide useful next actions.
- OG/live accounts do not show fake demo data.

6. Product Modules

Daily Check-In

Employees share daily work location, goals, focus, energy, and progress. This becomes the core recurring signal.

Task Progress

Tasks move through states such as not started, in progress, blocked, and completed. Blocked status requires context so managers can act.

Blocker Logs

Every blocker should be traceable: who is blocked, on what task, why, since when, and whether it is resolved.

NudgeSpace

A lightweight internal social/update space for team posts. The goal is to make wins, updates, and team energy visible without fake comments or forced social behavior.

NudgeAI

NudgeAI provides assistant answers, update scoring, daily summaries, delay analysis, inactivity nudges, burnout-care signals, sprint forecasts, standup briefs, anomaly checks, appreciation suggestions, and skill-gap analysis.

WhatsApp Nudge Bot

WhatsApp acts as a low-friction front door for check-ins. Employees can receive reminders and reply from WhatsApp; NudgeHQ stores the response and updates dashboards.

Growth Portal

Employees and HR can use progress history, completed work, proof links, streaks, blockers resolved, and update quality as evidence for development and reviews.

7. Architecture Overview

Frontend

- React 19
- Vite
- Tailwind-style utility classes
- Framer Motion
- Lucide React
- Recharts
- Main app/router in `src/App.jsx`
- Global styling in `src/index.css`

Backend

- Node.js
- Express
- Supabase/PostgreSQL
- JWT authentication
- bcryptjs password hashing
- Groq SDK for NudgeAI
- Nodemailer for email
- Razorpay payment foundation

- Twilio for WhatsApp
- Node cron for scheduled WhatsApp jobs

Data model

Core tables include organizations, users, departments, tasks, progress updates, blocker logs, reports, invitations, invite links, email verification, password resets, AI outputs, employee notifications, focus sessions, daily check-ins, and deep work sessions.

Integrations

- **Supabase:** database and live backend persistence.
- **Groq:** AI-powered summaries and assistant responses.
- **Twilio WhatsApp:** nudges, replies, blocker alerts, weekly wins.
- **Nodemailer:** verification, invites, contact form, password reset emails.
- **Razorpay:** payment foundation for India-focused billing.

8. Key Routes and APIs

Frontend routes

- / landing page
- /why - nudgehq product comparison page
- /contact contact page
- /faq FAQ page
- /nudgeai public NudgeAI page
- /signup, /login, /verify-email, /forgot-password, /reset-password
- /choose-plan, /payment, /onboarding
- /set-password, /accept-invite, /join/[code]
- /dashboard/admin, /dashboard/hr, /dashboard/manager, /dashboard/employee
- /demo sandbox demo console

Backend API groups

- /api/auth authentication, onboarding, invites, session
- /api/employees employee updates, dashboard, notifications, growth summary
- /api/tasks task CRUD and status updates
- /api/admin departments, employees, invites, updates, exports
- /api/analytics dashboard analytics
- /api/ai NudgeAI endpoints
- /api/focus Focus Pulse
- /api/checkin Smart Presence
- /api/deepwork Deep Work

- /api/reports board pack and reports
- /api/payment payment setup
- /api/contact contact form
- /api/notify/whatsapp WhatsApp notification workflow

9. Pricing Direction

NudgeHQ uses simple flat monthly plans. Starter packs have fixed limits; custom plans can be configured from 5 employees upward.

Plan	India price	USD price	Employee limit
Starter	■2,000/month	\$9/month	Up to 20 employees
Growth	■4,500/month	\$25/month	Up to 50 employees
Business	■8,500/month	\$49/month	Up to 100 employees
Custom	Custom	Custom	Any custom employee limit from 5+

Pricing is early-stage launch pricing and may change as the product grows.

10. Implementation Plan

Phase 1: Stabilize MVP foundations

- Keep demo and live product data separate.
- Ensure real accounts load real backend data or clear empty states.
- Fix stale pricing references across NudgeAI, landing, FAQ, and backend assistant copy.
- Confirm Supabase schema is fully applied in production project.
- Ensure auth/session flow does not log users out when visiting public pages.
- Harden onboarding plan limits and invite behavior.

Phase 2: Polish role dashboards

- Finish Manager dashboard as the next priority.
- Improve HR dashboard around people health, burnout risk, attendance, skill gaps, and reports.
- Improve Admin dashboard around company control, departments, roles, billing, and invites.
- Keep Employee dashboard focused on daily action: tasks, check-in, progress, blockers, growth.

Phase 3: WhatsApp production readiness

- Move from sandbox testing to approved WhatsApp sender when ready.
- Add clear phone-number collection during onboarding and profile settings.
- Add opt-out, resend, failure status, and admin preview controls.
- Confirm webhook reliability using Cloudflare Tunnel or deployed API URL.

- Log every notification: sent, skipped, failed, replied.

Phase 4: Reporting and evidence

- Improve 90-day growth PDF styling.
- Build admin/HR board pack reports.
- Add CSV/PDF exports for tasks, blockers, check-ins, and employee growth.
- Create report templates for weekly team review and monthly leadership review.

Phase 5: Production readiness

- Deploy frontend and backend to stable environments.
- Add environment setup documentation.
- Add CI checks for lint/build.
- Add route/API smoke tests.
- Improve email deliverability with domain email, SPF, DKIM, and DMARC.
- Add privacy/security review before external scale.

11. Future Product Plan

Near term: next 30 days

- Manager dashboard polish.
- HR dashboard polish.
- Admin dashboard polish.
- Real data curves and empty states across all OG dashboards.
- Twilio WhatsApp manual and scheduled nudges fully verified.
- Pricing copy and plan enforcement aligned across frontend/backend/NudgeAI.

Mid term: 60 days

- File uploads through Supabase Storage: profile images, company logos, proof screenshots, PDFs.
- Better onboarding UX and company branding.
- More robust NudgeSpace with live persistence and moderation basics.
- Board pack PDF generation and export quality upgrade.
- Role-based analytics filters by department, date, manager, and task status.

Longer term: 90+ days

- Custom WhatsApp branded sender.
- Slack/Teams integrations if customer demand appears.
- Advanced NudgeAI personalization by role, team, and employee history.
- More automation: recurring tasks, reminders, review cycles, recognition workflows.
- Customer-facing analytics and ROI dashboard.

- Security hardening for larger companies: SSO, audit logs, data retention controls.

12. Team Operating Rules

Product principles

- Do not add fake data to OG/live dashboards.
- Keep demo mode separate from real accounts.
- Keep employee actions lightweight.
- Make managers faster, not busier.
- Prefer clear empty states over fake activity.
- Build WhatsApp as a core feature, not a side add-on.
- Avoid bloated-suite thinking; NudgeHQ is the visibility layer.

Engineering rules

- Read `CONTEXT.md` and `ROUTES.md` before major changes.
- Do not touch `.env*` or secrets.
- Do not change database schema unless needed.
- Do not edit lockfiles unless dependencies change.
- Run lint/build after meaningful frontend changes.
- Treat auth, onboarding, payment, and invite flows as high-risk.

Design rules

- Keep the interface clean, modern, and B2B SaaS-oriented.
- Avoid unrelated navigation labels such as Labs, Studio, Shop, or other agency-style items.
- Avoid fake logos, fake comments, and fake customer claims.
- Keep dashboards full-page and command-center style where possible.
- Make modals dismiss on outside click where natural.

13. Risks and Open Questions

Product risks

- Employees may resist another daily workflow if it feels like surveillance.
- WhatsApp reminders must feel helpful, not spammy.
- AI outputs must be useful and safe, especially around burnout and people health.
- Managers need clear next actions, not more dashboards.

Technical risks

- Single large frontend file increases maintenance difficulty.
- AI and WhatsApp reliability depend on external services.
- Schema changes must stay synchronized across Supabase environments.

- Payment, invite, and auth flows need careful testing before launch.

Open questions

- Which customer segment should be first: startups, agencies, sales teams, HR-led companies, or operations-heavy teams?
- Should Custom pricing be self-serve with a calculator or sales-assisted?
- Which integration should follow WhatsApp: Slack, Teams, Jira, or Google Workspace?
- What is the minimum daily check-in that employees will actually complete consistently?

14. New Team Member First Week

Day 1: Understand the product

- Read this pack.
- Open the landing page and Why NudgeHQ page.
- Use the demo console.
- Log in as demo employee and demo admin if available.
- Understand the four roles: Admin, HR, Manager, Employee.

Day 2: Understand the codebase

- Read `CONTEXT.md` and `ROUTES.md`.
- Read `README.md` and `server/README.md`.
- Run frontend and backend locally.
- Review `src/App.jsx`, `src/index.css`, and `server/src/index.js`.

Day 3: Understand backend and data

- Review Supabase schema.
- Review auth, employees, tasks, admin, analytics, AI, and notification controllers.
- Review WhatsApp service and notification controller.
- Test key endpoints in Postman if needed.

Day 4: Pick a small contribution

Good first tasks:

- Fix copy mismatch.
- Improve empty state.
- Polish one dashboard card.
- Add a missing loading state.
- Improve one route doc.
- Test one API manually and document result.

Day 5: Ship with confidence

- Run lint/build.
- Verify the relevant page in browser.
- Write a clear summary of what changed.
- Avoid touching unrelated areas.

15. Current Priority Stack

- 1 Manager dashboard polish.
- 2 HR dashboard polish.
- 3 Admin dashboard polish.
- 4 WhatsApp workflow reliability.
- 5 Real-data curves and empty states.
- 6 Onboarding and invite reliability.
- 7 File uploads and proof storage.
- 8 PDF/board-pack reports.
- 9 Production deployment and CI.
- 10 Security/email/payment hardening.

16. Quick Local Setup

Frontend:

```
npm install
npm run dev
```

Backend:

```
cd server
npm install
cp .env.example .env
npm run dev
```

Database:

- 1 Open Supabase SQL editor.
- 2 Run `server/src/db/schema.sql`.
- 3 Run `server/src/db/seed.sql` if demo records are needed.

Useful checks:

```
npm run lint
npm run build
cd server && npm run dev
```

17. Final Note for New Teammates

NudgeHQ is still early, but the direction is clear: make team progress visible without making people feel monitored. The product should feel calm, fast, and useful. When in doubt, ask: does this reduce chasing, reveal blockers earlier, or help employees show their work better?

Internal-use note: This pack reflects the current beta direction and should be updated after major product, pricing, backend, or roadmap changes.